Claims Fair Handling and Escalation Procedure

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This synthetic internal procedure describes minimum handling steps for personal-lines and small-commercial property claims. It is a paraphrased training document, not regulatory text and not a substitute for current compliance guidance.

1. Acknowledge and guide

Confirm receipt of a claim, explain the next expected steps, and give the customer a clear route to provide relevant information. Tell the customer when an investigation is likely to take longer and why.

2. Make an evidence-led assessment

Identify the policy version and endorsements that applied on the loss date. Consider evidence both for and against the proposed outcome. Do not treat a missing document or an unresolved technical question as proof that an exclusion applies.

3. Decisions and escalation

- Escalate a proposed rejection based on an exclusion when the facts or wording are materially uncertain.
- Ask a technical lead to review conflicting reports or evidence of more than one cause.
- Record the relevant clauses, evidence, customer communications, and reasons for the outcome.
- Explain any decision in plain language, including important evidence that was not available.

4. Service and complaints

Handle claims without avoidable delay and treat customers consistently while taking individual circumstances into account. If a customer expresses dissatisfaction, follow the complaint-handling process and explain how to raise a formal complaint.